



Arms and Armor

As armies became more formal organizations and military strategy developed, so did weapons. Lighter, more flexible armor was used and the use of guns increased. However, despite their violent purpose, many weapons were exquisitely decorated.

[1] **Wooden powder belt** worn by a musketeer and containing measures of gunpowder. [2] **Italian close helmet**, dating to c. 1570 and elaborately decorated. This would have been worn during jousting tournaments. [3] **British matchlock gun**, dating from the 17th century. [4] **German wheellock pistol**, dating from 1590. [5] **Dutch flintlock pistol**, c. 1700, made by the Flemish gunmaker Guillame Henoul. [6] **Scottish pistol**, c. 1750, constructed from iron by Thomas Cadell of Doune. [7] **European hunting crossbow**, c. 1460. [8] **Decorated dagger** presented to the French king Henri IV by the city of Paris in 1598 to celebrate his marriage to Marie de Medici. [9] **Italian sword breaker**, which dates from c. 1660. The gaps in the steel blade were designed to trap the sword of an opponent, and wrench it from his grip or shatter the blade. [10] **Barbed arrowheads** dating from c. 1500, and probably used for hunting rather than warfare. [11] **Steel mace** with seven flanges, and typical of this type of weapon in the 16th

century. [12] **English hunting sword** from c. 1640. The iron hilt is decorated in silver. [13] **French sword**, dating from c. 1720, and made from silver with elaborate gold decoration. [14] **Italian equestrian armor**, designed to protect the head and neck of a horse in battle. This example dates to 1570. [15] **Closed helmet** with a pivoting visor from an Italian suit of armor, dating to the mid-16th century. Although constructed from metal plates, suits such as this were actually very light and flexible, providing top-to-toe protection in battle. [16] **Pauldrons** protected the shoulders and arms. [17] **Cuisses** were strapped to upper leg to protect the thigh and knee. [18] **The gorget** covered the neck and connected the helmet to the cuirass. [19] **Gauntlets** constructed from small, flexible plates protected the hands and wrists. [20] **Greaves** protected the lower legs and sabatons covered the feet. [21] **The cuirass** protected the torso and comprised the breast and back plates, which were attached to each other with leather straps.